Shri Harsha (1125–80): Indian exponent of the method of destructive argument (*vitanda*) who attempted in his *Khandanakhandakhadya* to establish the *Advaita-Vedantin* belief that the only genuine reality is undifferentiated reflexive and self-established awareness. He argues that both our reliable means of knowledge and the categories to which the realist ascribes objective existence are in fact indefinable and just matters of human convention. His method is to examine the definitions proposed by his opponents and to demonstrate that they involve inconsistencies. The only certainty is that self-aware (*svayam prakasha*) consciousness alone exists.

His negative criticisms of the definitions proposed by ***Nyaya-Vaisheshika*** thinkers prompted the often highly technical and sophisticated reformulations developed by the ***Navya-Nyaya*** school.

Further reading: Ganeri 2001a; Granoff 1978; Phillips 1996; Ram-Prasad 2002

Shruti (what has been heard): the ***Vedas*** and ***Upanishads*** are believed by mainstream orthodox Hindus to be authorless (*apaurusheya*), eternal and infallible when they refer to anything supernatural. The relation between the sound of a scriptural word and its object is innate, sounds participating in the natures of their referents. *Shruti* is held to be the only reliable means of knowledge (***pramana***) about the supernatural that is beyond sensory perception (***pratyaksha***) and inference (***anumana***).

Vedanta is the systematic interpretation of *shruti* statements about God, the soul and the origination of the cosmos.

There is also a body of literature known as ***smriti*** ('what has been remembered', that is, traditional) whose function is to clarify and support *shruti*. These works, which include the *Mahabharata*, ***Bhagavad Gita*** and